

Apply to be a Science Corps Fellow - Entry #3362

Name
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Gender
Male
Residence: City (State), Country
Bengaluru (Karnataka), India
Nationality
INDIAN
When did you or do you expect to complete your PhD?
2024
Please tell us briefly about your university education (institution, city, country, year)
Degree: Doctor of Philosophy 2018 - 2024 Institute: Ashoka Trust for Research in Ecology and the Environment (ATREE), Manipal Academy of Higher Education (MAHE) Thesis title: Identifying potential drivers of invasion and assessing the extent of niche shift in globally invasive vertebrates City: Bengaluru, INDIA Integrated M.Sc. (Life Science) 2013 - 2018 National Institute of Technology Rourkela Thesis title: Study of Salmonella mediated dauer formation in Caenorhabditis elegans City: Rourkela, INDIA
Why would you like to be a Science Corps Fellow?
I want to be a Science Corps Fellow for two reasons: firstly, it is a great opportunity for those who are interested in teaching. Secondly, the vision of Science Corps is also to provide education to those who need the most with limited resources. I believe the latter makes the job more appealing. Because it makes us think and be more innovative, and makes the education style more inclusive. Certainly, this experience will shape me to become a better educator.

In addition to your studies, please describe any prior experience that may help you as a Science Corps Fellow.

During my PhD, I have received many opportunities to mentor interns. Additionally, I have been invited to train scientists, researchers through different workshops. I must mention that I am keen on teaching young students. As a result, I organised a workshop "Know your field through Pixels" at the Student Conference on Conservation Science 2024, Bengaluru, INDIA. It has received good feedback that can be supported by the invitation from the conference organisers to repeat the workshop this year. I was also involved in teaching Research Data Management to the graduate students at NCBS, Bengaluru, INDIA.

Earlier, during my undergrad studies, as a part of National Social Service (NSS), I used to go to the nearby schools to teach the kids from a marginalised background.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Scientist in academia
 Administrative role in industry or academia
 In science education

Please expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (~2 year) and long-term (~10 year) future.

Short-term plan

I want to be in academia, especially in the teaching & research profession. Shortly, I am looking for postdoctoral fellow positions. This will help me understand the challenges of working independently with support from a supervisor. Also, I want to expand my expertise in the ecological sciences.

Long-term plan

I aim to continue my research in macroecology and invasive species, with a focus on India, by establishing a lab. The

country is currently experiencing rapid growth, putting pressure on its urban agglomerations. I want to study the trees in cities (such as parks and university campuses) and compare them to their counterparts in the wild.

- (a) Assessing the change in the ecosystem in the peri-urban cluster of India
- (b) To compare the functional characteristics of the same species in natural and introduced environments
- (c) Effect of climate change on the species range
- (d) Effect of exotic plant species on the native fauna (birds & insects)

Besides the research work, I will be happy to apply for appropriate research grants, and disseminate the outcomes through conferences, popular articles and research articles.

Please upload your CV (.pdf)

 [Biswa-Bhusana-Mahapatra-CV.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

Other

[Science Corps](#)